Assignment 1F: AI Collaboration Analysis and Critical Reflection

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1. AI Process and Prompt Log

I used Donna, my personal AI system built around OpenClaw, throughout different stages of Assignment 1. OpenAI ChatGPT/Codex was also documented during the 1D collaboration. The system could use different models for different tasks, but the exact underlying model names and versions were not consistently recorded. I will not guess them. I also used GitHub for coursework and project evidence, Zotero for research sources, and document and visualization tools for charts and exports. Those are supporting tools, not interchangeable names for the AI system.

1A - Reflective essay

Donna’s contribution: Reviewed my assignment for missing requirements, irrelevant material, spelling, and grammar. Adjusted essay formatting, checked the PDF, and uploaded the PDF and editable copy to the correct GitHub folder.

My review and decisions: I reviewed the presentation and asked for proper essay formatting. This record concerns final submission review, basic language checks, formatting, and file management.

1B - Strategic framework

Donna’s contribution: Assisted with U.S. job-posting research, discussion of my career direction, requirement checks, basic language checks, document formatting, and repository preparation.

My review and decisions: I defined the U.S. research scope and clarified my time and AI budget. I reviewed the comparison and kept distinctions between actual job requirements and my longer-term interests.

1C - Career visualization

Donna’s contribution: Helped with research and feedback, explored my ideas through conversation, produced graphs from information I supplied, checked basic language and requirements, and prepared the visuals and documents.

My review and decisions: I corrected C to C++, supplied more of my hardware and design experience, reviewed the ratings, and treated the skill chart as self-assessment rather than objective proof of proficiency.

1D - AI collaboration and career futures

Donna’s contribution: Challenged my strategy, proposed two conditional career scenarios, asked follow-up questions, and helped organize and present the exchange.

My review and decisions: I confirmed that automation and integration interested me most. I corrected the current status of my email workflow and challenged an overly simple distinction between learning and building. I kept the scenarios as possibilities, not predictions.

1E - Future modeling and planning

Donna's contribution: Helped inspect projects and contribution evidence, conduct research, develop the written analysis and rubrics, create charts, prepare the PDF, and organize the repository and Zotero sources.

My review and decisions: I corrected the description of my role in Tesseract, distinguished functioning memory workflows from unresolved retrieval freshness, set programming to 2 and debugging to 3, and rejected unnecessary banner and review labels. I kept the first 18 PDF pages intact and added one page on weight-space programming. The final PDF has 19 pages and six annotated sources were saved in the shared course Zotero collection. I am currently building a Rust-based retrieval project called Enigma-MCP. It is ongoing work, not a completed implementation.

Selected instructions and exact prompts

1A - Submission review and file management, October 7. My collaboration-log entry records the instruction to check requirements, relevance, spelling, and grammar, improve formatting, and upload the final files. The entry is a summary of my instructions, not a verbatim prompt. The original exact prompt is not established by that record. I am not assigning any additional AI role to 1A.

1B - Planning before starting, October 7.

> Make a plan to go in a direction to complete 1B. Tell me what you need, ask me questions before we go ahead. I want it to be perfect.

1B - Research boundaries, October 7.

> I want to focus on U.S.-related jobs. It doesn't have to be New York-specific, but it has to be U.S.-specific, in the United States. And my budget of AI usage that I meant was $20 to $60 per month, including existing subscription, not additional.

1C - Reviewing skills, October 7.

> So, propose ratings from my 1B self-assessment for me to review and also ask me extra questions that you better help you do the proficiency rating because I also have some other skills. Like I got very basic knowledge in C. I work with OpenClaw, I worked with Hermes, then I know how to navigate GitHub. I have some hardware skills in building PCs and fixing them, like they might not all be related or required, but I'm just giving you a set. I work and fix hardware as well. I can mod my gaming controller so on and so forth. Like I said, I'm all over the place. I can use graphic design tools like Adobe as well, so yeah.

1C - Correcting the record, October 7.

> knowledge in C++ not C

1D - Starting the strategy exchange, October 12. Verbatim excerpt preserved in the submitted 1D document:

> Bring up my next assignment and do a full audit of the repos and zotero repo before we begin. Let's start doing 1D. Make an end goal, make a full plan from first to finish about completing 1D. Let's go through it together as we talk to each other to get everything we need before we execute it.

1D - Challenging the learning sequence, October 14. Verbatim excerpts preserved in 1D:

> I believe reliability and understanding should come first in order to build a much stronger and efficient system.
>
> most of the understanding and reliability comes from rebuilding it or building something new

1E - Adding a research interest, November 11. Exact prompt from my OpenClaw collaboration record:

> Remember the research I was doing regarding white space programming and how I found it really interesting. I want you to mention that as an addition of my future endeavors based on how we researched it.

The process record above focuses on the prompts and decisions that materially shaped the assignments. It does not claim to reproduce every message from the conversations. The 1A account follows the existing collaboration-log entry. The 1B and 1C prompts come from the archived conversations, the 1D excerpts from the submitted assignment, and the 1E prompt is reproduced as I recorded it in my OpenClaw workflow.

2. Critical Reflection

AI helped me complete Assignment 1 more efficiently, but it did not choose my career for me. I was already interested in automation, AI systems, creative technology, and game development. Donna helped organize those interests, compare them against actual opportunities, and turn scattered information into work I could review. It saved time, especially on research, formatting, charts, and file management. The more important lesson was learning when to rely on AI and when to do the work myself.

For 1A, Donna's recorded role was limited to reviewing the assignment before submission, checking for missing requirements or irrelevant content, and checking spelling and grammar. It also handled formatting, PDF review, and repository uploads. I reviewed the presentation and requested proper essay formatting. That was useful because I could concentrate on reviewing the finished document instead of spending more time managing files.

In 1B and 1C, AI helped me research job listings and visualize my skills. The comparison tables, SWOT matrix, and skills chart made the gaps in my current abilities easier to see. However, presentation can create false confidence. A clean chart does not make my self-ratings objective, and a few job advertisements cannot describe an entire industry. I had to correct details, including C versus C++, and distinguish what employers actually requested from what I hoped to learn. I used the source listings and my own experience to review those conclusions.

The 1D conversation showed a different limitation. AI questioned whether reliability and understanding should come before optimization. I cared about reliability, but I disagreed with the idea that understanding must be finished before building. I learn by researching, trying things, making mistakes, fixing them, and rebuilding. AI's challenge was useful because I could push back and get a recommendation that better matched how I work. The discussion clarified my interest in automation, but it did not replace my judgment.

For 1E, verification became even more important. I separated the memory workflows that function in my setup from the unresolved problem of outdated retrieval results. I also kept my programming and debugging scores realistic. Repository evidence, contribution records, job postings, and research saved in Zotero were stronger support than a confident AI response. Studying weight-space programming is an ongoing research interest, not evidence that I have implemented it. I am currently building my own Rust retrieval project called Enigma-MCP, which is still in development.

The more I have used AI, the more I have returned to traditional learning, including hand coding and working through problems myself. That might sound backward, but it helps me understand what the tool is doing and recognize when an answer is weak. I still use AI to explore ideas and make better use of limited time. I just do not want speed to become a substitute for understanding. My goal is to become more capable at the work, not simply faster at producing documents.

3. Academic Integrity and Attribution

The ideas, experiences, self-assessments, career direction, and conclusions throughout Assignment 1 came from me. I chose the topics, set the priorities, evaluated the evidence, corrected mistakes, and decided what stayed in each submission. Donna mainly helped me work faster and handle supporting tasks. In 1A, that meant submission review, basic language checks, formatting, PDF review, and file uploads. In 1B through 1E, it also assisted with research, discussion, drafting and revisions, charts, and document preparation. I reviewed and directed this work instead of accepting its output automatically. External sources were recorded in Zotero. I follow CUNY's Academic Integrity Policy by acknowledging AI-shaped text, analysis, and visuals where used. The responsibility for what my assignments say, and whether those claims are accurate, remains mine.